

RoomFinder

Business Model Canvas - Student Accommodation Agent App

Key Partners • Landlords with permitted/registered houses • Hostel managers • USTED administration (for endorsement and student access) • Mobile money providers (for fee collection) • Local transport/logistics providers	Key Activities • Managing, updating and maintaining the online platform • Verifying landlords, hostels, and listings them. • Customer support services for students and landlords • Leading students to available rooms • Marketing and advertising	Value Propositions • An agent app that helps students quickly find and secure accommodation (hostel or rented room) • listings hostel that has been verified to lower the possibility of fraud • A direct phone line for quick follow-up between agents and landlords • Easy registration and transparent pricing.	Customer Relationships • Search and filter tool inside the app • Student and landlord personal details uploaded and stored on the app • Landlord-agent interaction is handled by phone calls • Customer support available for booking and complaints	Customer Segments • Students at universities looking for hostel or room accommodation (primary segment) • Landlords who have rooms or hostels available for rent (secondary segment)
	Key Resources • Mobile/web technology platform • Logistics and delivery network for inspections • Verified landlord and property database • Support team • Working capital		Channels • Websites and Mobile apps • Social media advertising (Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, Twitter) • Posters and tools for campus communication • Referrals and word-of mouth	
Cost Structure • System/platform maintenance and hosting • Salaries for employees and support • Verification and inspection logistics • Marketing and advertising costs		Revenue Streams • Registration fee: GHS 70.00 per student • Commission fee: a percentage of the room price, charged per successful booking		

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Business Plan Details

1. BUSINESS IDEA

RoomFinder is an agent app that connects university students with landlords who have hostel rooms or rooms for rent. As a group completing an Information Technology programme and being unable to find suitable employment, this venture is being pursued as a way to stay self-employed, creative, and in control of our own work, while solving a real life problem that almost every student faces same time finding safe and affordable accommodation quickly.

2. VALUE PROPOSITION

Helps students find hostel or room accommodation quickly through one app, instead of walking around campus or relying on rumors.

Every listing is linked to a verified landlord, reducing the risk of scams and fake rooms.

Direct phone contact between the agent and the landlord speeds up confirmation and booking.

Simple, transparent pricing: a fixed registration fee plus a commission tied to the room price, so students know costs upfront.

3. CUSTOMER RELATIONS

Search and filter tool inside the app lets students select rooms by price, location, and type.

Students and landlords upload their personal details on the app, creating a basic verified profile for both sides.

Once a student shows interest, the agent calls the landlord directly to confirm availability and arrange viewing or booking.

Ongoing relationship is maintained through follow-up calls and support during the booking process.

4. MARKET AND CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

➤ Primary Segment

University students looking for hostel or rented rooms, especially new and continuing students each semester/academic year.

➤ Secondary Segment

Landlords and hostel owners with permitted houses who want reliable tenants and fewer vacant rooms.

Customer validation has focused primarily on students, since they are the most active and recurring users of the platform in every academic cycle.

5. CHANNELS

Mobile app and website where students search listings and landlords register their properties.

Advertising and communication tools, including social media platforms (Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, Twitter) to reach students.

Campus-based promotion (posters, word-of-mouth, student ambassadors) during orientation and new-semester periods.

6. REVENUE STREAMS AND PRICING MODEL

Registration fee: a flat **GHS 70.00** charged to students when they sign up and start using the app's *search* and *booking features*.

Commission fee: an additional percentage charged based on the price of the room booked, paid once a booking is confirmed through the app.

This dual model creates an upfront, predictable income from registrations while the commission scales revenue with the value of each booking.

7. KEY ACTIVITIES

Customer support: assisting students and landlords with registration, searches, and booking issues.

Online platform management: keeping the app and website running, updated, and free of fake or outdated listings.

Verifying landlords and properties before they are listed.

Coordinating phone-based communication between agents and landlords.

8. KEY RESOURCES

Technology platform: the mobile app and website that power search, registration, and listings.

Logistics and delivery network: used for verifying properties and supporting communication between students and landlords.

A small support team to manage day-to-day customer service and platform upkeep.

9. KEY PARTNERS

Landlords with permitted houses, who are the source of all accommodation listed on the app.

Hostel operators offering rooms to students.

Potential partnership with the university for official recognition and easier access to students.

Mobile money providers, to support fee payments and commissions.

10. COST STRUCTURE

System maintenance: keeping the app, website, and database running smoothly and securely.

Staff costs: support team and any agents handling landlord communication.

Verification and logistics costs: travel and checks needed to confirm landlords and properties are genuine.

Marketing costs: social media advertising and campus promotion to attract students and landlords.

Diagram

